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YES YOU CAN: SOCIO-EMOTIONAL SKILLS FOR HIGHER EMPLOYABILITY IN TURKEY

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Abbreviations

ALMP	Active labor market policy
ATT	Average treatment effect on the treated
BIT	Behavioral Insights Team
DiD	Difference-in-differences
ITT	Intention-to-treat
İŞKUR	Turkish Employment Agency
JSS	Job search skills
JVC	Job and vocational counselor
MCII	Mental contrasting with implementation intentions
SES	Socioemotional skills

YES YOU CAN: SOCIO-EMOTIONAL SKILLS FOR HIGHER EMPLOYABILITY IN TURKEY ^{1,2}

ABSTRACT

This report summarizes the results of a large-scale randomized controlled trial designed to analyze the impact of a pilot intervention aimed at supporting jobseekers in their pursuit of successful labor market (re)integration. The intervention was implemented in Turkey in the context of the existing employment support services of the Turkish Employment Agency (İŞKUR) with a focus on young jobseekers (15-29 years of age) and women. As part of the program, jobseekers were provided with a brochure including labor market and job search strategies information to influence their employment expectations. The program also included a training session to inform and set job search goals and practical strategies to persevere and sustain the motivation to overcome obstacles and setbacks during the job search. The results show that exposure to this intervention results in positive and significant effects on job search behaviors and take-up of İŞKUR services.

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² The team would like to thank İŞKUR for assistance and collaboration. In particular, the Foreign Relations and Projects, Job and Vocational Counselling, and Information Technologies Departments and İŞKUR Provincial Directorates of Istanbul, Ankara, Izmir, Bursa, Kocaeli and Konya, as well as the İŞKUR service center directors where the pilot program took place, and all the Jobs and Vocational Counselors that participated and delivered the intervention. The team also gratefully acknowledges the support of the Jobs Umbrella Trust Fund, which made this project possible.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

In Turkey, the years between 2012 and 2017 saw a steadily rising labor force participation rate but also of unemployment. New workers, including women and youth, joined those already in the market increasing the competition for available jobs. At the same time, employers, albeit the increased numbers of jobseekers, reported difficulties finding workers with appropriate workplace competencies when filling vacancies, particularly when it came to job-related behaviors.

The Turkish Employment Agency (İŞKUR) and the World Bank teamed-up to test whether providing jobseekers with more labor market information and with short training focused on socioemotional skills and goal-setting and planning could impact their job search intensity. This exercise aimed to inform İŞKUR's ongoing efforts to provide a broader package of services to jobseekers.

In 2015, the World Bank conducted an in-depth study to identify which behavioral factors were affecting Turkish jobseekers in their job search. The study found that there was a combination of *limited self-awareness* and *lack of accurate information* about local labor market leading to unrealistic job search goals, and *lack of follow-through* resulting in frustration and discouragement after job search setbacks. These two findings shaped the focus of the training program evaluated in this report. The first suggested that jobseekers would benefit from user-friendly information on the local labor market to improve the match between their aspirations and the local labor market reality. The second, that the provision of strategies for iterative goal-setting, identification of constraints, and creation of feasible plans to overcome them could increase persistence in job search. The pilot expected to address both challenges with the objective to increase job search breadth and intensity.

The final pilot intervention consisted of two parts – an informational brochure (or the *Job Search Skills (JSS) Primer*) and a socioemotional skills training (or the *SES Training*). The program was offered to newly registered jobseekers in 18 randomly-selected İŞKUR centers in five provinces across Turkey where trends in job creation suggested the presence of a dynamic labor market (Ankara, Bursa, Istanbul, Izmir, and Kocaeli).

The Job Search Skills Primer consisted of a brochure to be distributed to all newly registered jobseekers in the centers where the intervention was taking place. The main objective of the *JSS Primer* was to ensure that jobseekers have adequate and timely information to form and adjust their job search expectations, their job aspirations, and the expected returns to increased job search effort. In addition, the primer raised awareness about İŞKUR services and provided basic job search tips. It was delivered to jobseekers in either printed or online formats, depending on their method of registration (in person or online).

The objective of the *Socioemotional Skills Training* was to equip jobseekers with sustained motivation for job search and to provide them with a metacognitive strategy – on planning and acting on plans – in order to influence their job search intensity and their persistence and resilience in the job search. The training consisted of a single session of about 1.5 hours, delivered to groups of up to 15 newly

registered jobseekers by a trained İŞKUR Jobs and Vocational Counselor (JVC). The session was divided into three modules: a brief self-affirmation exercise, an interactive discussion of job search barriers and solutions using case studies, and a step-by-step individual goal-setting and planning exercise. Newly registered jobseekers were recruited for the *SES Training* by either a combination of SMS and phone call invitations or through on-site invitations.

By the end of the intervention period (April-October 2018), the *SES Training* was delivered to 2,216 jobseekers, while the Primer was widely distributed to new registrants. Take-up was low with only 4.5 percent of all who were reached attending the trainings. The final evaluation sample consisted of 3,994 jobseekers distributed among those who attended the *SES Training*; non-compliers with *SES Training* invitation; and individuals in the control group (newly registered jobseekers in the 10 İŞKUR centers in the pilot provinces where the program was not implemented).

The evaluation focused on two types of effects: 1) the impact of offering the intervention (*JSS Primer* and *SES Training*) and 2) the impact of exposure to *SES Training* (i.e. participation in this short training, which was more likely to be taken up by males, labor market entrants, and more highly educated jobseekers). The main results of the evaluation can be summarized as follows:

- **The offer of *JSS Primer* had a significant and positive effect on the take-up of almost all İŞKUR services, and the offer of *SES Training* increased the take-up of job-counselling sessions.** Jobseekers in treatment centers, all of whom were offered the *JSS Primer* when they registered, were 19 percentage points more likely to participate in the Job Search Skills course, 2 percentage points more likely participate in Vocational Training courses, and 6 percentage points more likely to attend meetings with JVCs (i.e. job counselling sessions). Moreover, jobseekers were 4 percentage points more likely to attend an On-the-Job Training and 3 percentage points more likely to attend an entrepreneurship skills training. Given the low take-up rate for *SES Training*, the impact of simply offering this short training program did not result in much observable change, but the increase in job counselling sessions for those who did participate was large enough to be observed even when non-compliers were included in the analysis.
- **The exposure to *SES Training* had a significant impact on instilling a growth mindset (i.e. belief in personal change).** When comparing of those who participated in *SES Training* to a subset of control group jobseekers (who would have been likely to take it up, “would-be takers”) the analysis shows a statistically significant treatment effect on growth mindset but not on other measured socioemotional skills. This finding suggests that the treatment was successful in broadening the mindset of the participants and potentially making them more open for their labor market search efforts and arising opportunities.
- **Exposure to the *SES Training* delivers large and statistically significant treatment effects on the take-up of a whole suite of İŞKUR services.** *SES Training* graduates were significantly more likely to take up all other İŞKUR offers, relative to would-be takers. Treatment effects are particularly large for the immediate job search services, such as the Job Search Skills course and job counselling sessions with their JVCs, but also statistically

significant for the three different types of training programs. These overall results hold equally for men and women. For younger jobseekers, there are significant and large treatment effects for the take-up of Job Search Skills training and for the take-up of on-the-job training. And older job seekers also see significant and large increases in the uptake of all types of İŞKUR courses.

- **The job search intensity impacts of exposure to *SES Training* are different for male and female jobseekers.** One key mechanism for *SES Training* impacts seems to be a shift in the overall labor market activity towards job search. For the male participants, this shift seems to come at the expense of dismissing short-term employment opportunities for investing in job search. The shift towards an increased search intensity is reflected in the significantly increased use of job search channels for both genders. For female jobseekers the analysis also suggested an in the immediate rise in job applications per week.

While challenges with take-up of training complicated the delivery and analysis of the pilot program, this work still delivers important lessons for policy makers seeking to improve their employment services:

- First, given that brochures are a relatively low-cost intervention, the observed impacts from offering the *JSS Primer* to newly-registered jobseekers are encouraging. When information is provided in a timely and with a user-centered design and language, jobseekers are more likely to take up intermediation and training services that could be important for their job search. Given these impacts and the relatively low cost of printing and distributing the *JSS Primer*, one recommendation of this study is to scale up the Job Search Skills Primer distribution to all newly-registered jobseekers. Second, for policymakers considering a socioemotional skills training for jobseekers, the evidence provided by this project shows further design adjustments might be needed. While the offer of this very short training program did not result in significant behavioral changes, the exposure to it had impacts on job search behavior and take-up of employment services.

Some of the challenges policy makers will need to address to enhance the impacts of these types of program going forward are: How to increase the take-up rate of these trainings, and how better similar interventions to different types of jobseekers. Policy makers can perhaps consider providing information on the impacts of the training to potential enrollees to demonstrate its value, and creating more homogeneous training groups to enhance the quality of discussion among group participants. In addition, increased intervention intensity may improve impacts for participants.

1. INTRODUCTION

Socioemotional skills have been demonstrated to be key for an individual's success in different aspects of life, from education, to healthy behaviors, to labor market outcomes (Heckman and Kautz 2012).³ Inasmuch as these skills concern how people relate to others, perceive themselves, and manage their emotions, socioemotional skills have an influence on all areas of life. Importantly, as is the case with cognitive skills, socioemotional skills can be developed and trained (Chernyshenko et al. 2018). Among the areas where socioemotional skills are valued and needed, labor markets are central. Evidence from employer surveys shows that these skills are important factors in the choice between candidates for a job (Guerra et al. 2014, Ibarraran et al. 2015), and several studies show that employers seek these skills and prioritize them when assessing skills needs (Manpower 2018, Acosta et al. 2017).

Socioemotional skills are also essential for successful job search. Jobseekers put these skills to use throughout their job search, as it is a process that requires, among others, self-awareness, self-efficacy, perseverance, resilience to setbacks, and frustration tolerance. Several authors note that the process of active job seeking is not only taxing in these skills, but it is sometimes thwarted by their inadequacy. For example, procrastination and low job search intensity can be associated with low self-control and motivation, high degree of present bias (Krueger and Mueller 2012, Babcock et al. 2012, Falk et al. 2006, DellaVigna and Paserman 2005), as well as a higher propensity to believe that events in one's life are the result of uncontrollable forces (i.e. external locus of control, as documented by Caliendo et al. 2015). Job search intensity can be predicted by the level of goal orientation and self-regulation observed among jobseekers (Creed et al. 2009). The Behavioral Insights Team (BIT) in the United Kingdom conducted an intervention with jobseekers that introduced job search planning and commitment to the implementation of the plan. The so-called BIT Jobcentre Plus intervention (BIT 2015, Gallagher et al. 2015) found that supporting jobseekers with practical goal-setting and planning tools had a positive effect on job search intensity and likelihood of reemployment.

In general, while there is a burgeoning body of empirical research demonstrating that socioemotional skills could be critical determinants of success in the labor market and the job search, less is known about how these skills can be cultivated. The literature that is available on such socioemotional skills interventions has mostly focused on school-age populations in a developed country context. One important exception is the Juventud y Empleo program in the Dominican Republic, the short- and longer-term effects of which have been rigorously evaluated (Ibarraran et al. 2015).

³ Also referred to as 'social and emotional skills', 'socio-behavioral skills,' 'non-cognitive,' or 'soft' skills. For the purpose of this report, we will use the term socioemotional skills to refer to the personality or psychological attributes that enable individuals to navigate interpersonal and social situations, such as the labor market or school, effectively and that are amenable to change and development –are malleable— over the life cycle (following Guerra et al. (2014)).

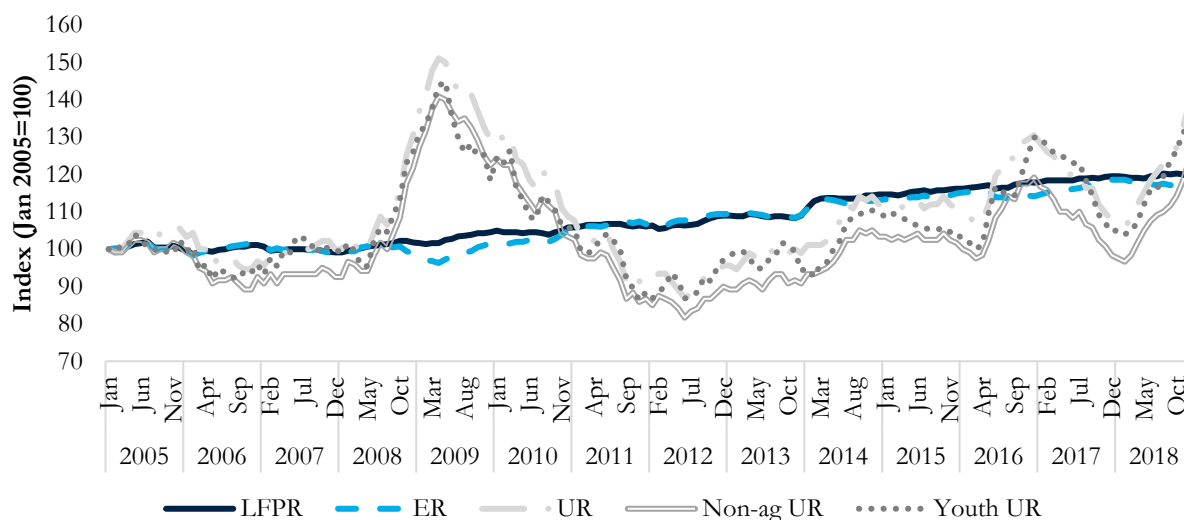
The current research aims to contribute to the literature on development of socioemotional skills among the working-age population and on doing so in a developing country context. Given the increasing recognition of the importance of these skills on youth employability and the rising interest in integrating socioemotional skills training in active labor market programs (ALMPs) provided to jobseekers (Heckman and Kautz 2013, Cunningham et al. 2016, Cardona Vasco et al. 2015, Sanchez Puerta et al. 2016), the study provides evidence that can be used in designing and implementing such training modules in order to improve the effectiveness of job search assistance services, documented as the more cost-effective ALMPs (Card et al. 2010 and 2018). We examine the impact of a pilot intervention that provides jobseekers with information and evidence-based tools to plan and persevere in the job search process, including practical strategies to sustain the motivation to overcome obstacles and setbacks in pursuit of successful labor market (re)integration.

The intervention was implemented in Turkey in partnership with Turkish Employment Agency (İŞKUR), in the context of their existing support to jobseekers. The Turkish context presented a good opportunity to test whether a program focused on socioemotional skills to support the job search could impact job search intensity. Turkey had experienced a substantial improvement in labor market conditions following the 2008/9 crisis, with unemployment going from 15% of labor force during the crisis to 9.7% in 2013. Over the 2005-2018 period, labor force participation increased from 46.4% of population aged 15+ to 53.2%, mostly due to the rapid rise in female labor force participation. Figure 1 below presents the evolution of main labor market indicators for the 2005-2018 period, ending with the year the pilot intervention examined in this paper was conducted. It shows that between mid-2012 and early 2017, the unemployment rate was rising, with a sharp increase in 2016 when the current pilot intervention was being designed. Combined with the steadily rising labor force participation rate, this higher unemployment rate implies a significant increase in the number of unemployed people. Indeed, the seasonally-adjusted number of unemployed at the start of the implementation of the intervention in April 2018 (at 3.086 million) was very close to that experienced around the peak of the financial crisis (around 3.3 million). Around 22% of the unemployed stay unemployed for a year or longer (i.e. are long-term unemployed). At the same time, youth unemployment rate has always been higher than the total unemployment rate. For the 2014-2015 period, young men's (15-29) unemployment rate was almost double the unemployment rate of men in the 30-39 age group (14.7% vs 7.1%). The same disparity can be observed by disaggregating by sex, with female unemployment levels being much higher than men's (19.1% and 11.6%) during the same period, with women also much more likely to be long-term unemployed.⁴ Moreover, according to a Manpower survey conducted in 2012, employers in Turkey reported significant difficulties with finding workers with appropriate workplace competencies when filling vacancies (see Figure 2) (Manpower 2012). For these reasons, supporting

⁴ Indeed, women in Turkey are also more likely than men to spend more than 12 months in unemployment, and although the number of jobseekers spending 12 or more months unemployed has declined in Turkey over the year of 2018 for both sexes, women are still more likely than men to be in long term unemployment.

socioemotional skills development of jobseekers, particularly women and youth, could be expected to contribute to improved labor market outcomes in Turkey.

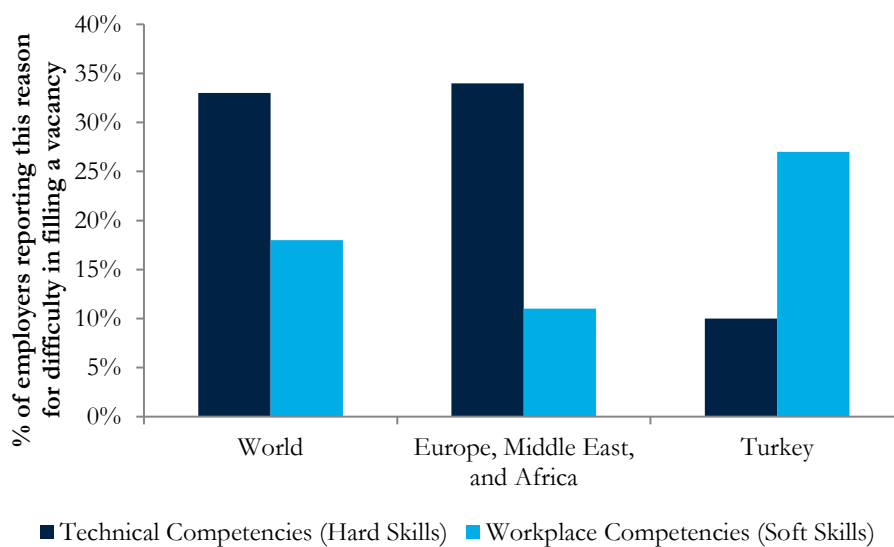
Figure 1: Turkey, main labor market indicators, 2005-2018



Source: TurkStat, Labour Force Statistics, Jan 2005 – Dec 2018.

Note: Seasonally-adjusted data.

Figure 2: Workplace Competencies as a constraint to filling vacancies, Turkey and comparators, 2012



Source: Manpower Global Talent Shortage Survey 2012.

The institution responsible for providing active labor market policies and intermediation services in Turkey is the Turkish Employment Agency (İŞKUR). At the start of the project (May 2016) İŞKUR had 2.37 million registered unemployed individuals as their clients. İŞKUR services include vocational training, entrepreneurship programs, job placement, jobs and vocational counseling services (via JVCs), on-the job training, trainings to special groups (such as incarcerated individuals or women residing in shelters), and administration of unemployment benefits, among others.

Since 2011, and as part of its efforts to improve employability and better serve jobseekers, İŞKUR restructured the position of the job and vocational counselor (JVC) and deployed them all over the country.⁵ All new registered jobseekers are assigned a JVC in the İŞKUR center that covers the jobseekers' residential address. JVCs are responsible for registering jobseekers at İŞKUR centers, providing individualized guidance to jobseekers via job counseling sessions, engaging with local employers and expanding the pool of vacancies available at the center, and assessing jobseekers' needs and potential services to be offered to individual jobseekers, among other tasks. In addition, İŞKUR introduced the job search skills training program, which intended to facilitate job search and help jobseekers attain their job search goals; JVCs were responsible for delivering these job search skills trainings to individual jobseekers in İŞKUR centers and to groups participating in vocational training courses as well as delivering them via lectures in vocational high schools, prisons, and women's shelters. At the start of the pilot, there were around 4,000 JVCs across all İŞKUR centers, with an average case load of 688 registered unemployed jobseekers per JVC.

Over the last several years, İŞKUR has focused on improving its services in order to better support its clients.⁶ The current intervention focusing on jobseekers' socioemotional skills was thus an integral part of İŞKUR's effort to provide a more holistic package of services to jobseekers within its existing institutional structure - from outreach to jobseekers, to training delivery.

The rest of this paper is structured as follows. The next section describes the design and implementation of the intervention, including previous studies that have informed this pilot, and the randomized control trial evaluation setup. Section 3 details the data sources and evaluation methodology used to estimate the impacts of the pilot intervention. The results of the pilot intervention are discussed in Section 4. The final section presents conclusions and policy implications.

⁵ JVCs are contracted public employees who have, as a minimum, an undergraduate degree, have sat the Public Personnel Selection Exam (KPSS) and professionally qualified to be a Job and Vocational Counsellor.

⁶ This process has included an evaluation of the effectiveness of İŞKUR's technical and vocational training programs (conducted by the World Bank, for details see World Bank 2013 and Hirshleifer 2016). The recommendations of the evaluation report included adding behavioral skills to the existing vocational training programs, and incentivizing job search by training participants on job search skills.

2. THE INTERVENTION AND EVALUATION SETUP

While departing from the identified need to introduce socioemotional skills in İŞKUR services and a literature-informed pre-identification of potential socioemotional skills that are intensively used in job search, the specific details of the pilot were defined after preliminary fieldwork (i.e. a prior study). Specifically, a local team conducted a behavioral diagnosis in September-October 2015 based on visits to six İŞKUR centers in three provinces (Istanbul, Kocaeli, and Ankara). These visits included non-participatory observation of the environment in these centers, including the flow of jobseekers through the center when they came to register with İŞKUR or receive İŞKUR services, observations of counseling sessions conducted by JVCs with jobseekers, interviews with jobseekers, and a combination of focus group discussions and in-depth one-on-one interviews with JVCs. The fieldwork also included the collection of short psychometric questionnaires for jobseekers.

The prior study was used to identify the priority constraints experienced by Turkish jobseekers in terms of socioemotional skills.⁷ It revealed that jobseekers often struggle with setting realistic job search goals. In particular, many jobseekers tended to have very high expectations in terms of salary and work conditions relative to their qualifications and the available jobs in the local labor market. This finding implied that provision of strategies for iterative goal-setting, identification of constraints, and creation of feasible plans to overcome constraints or adjustment of goals may improve the match between aspirations and reality and increase job search breadth and intensity. Moreover, interviews with JVCs suggested that many jobseekers lacked follow-through, attributed failures to situations outside of one's own control, and became easily discouraged after experiencing rejection during the job search process. This was confirmed by the analysis of the collected psychometric questionnaires, which revealed a tendency to exhibit external locus of control, i.e. external attribution of events in one's life. Thus, improving resilience to setbacks and strategies for sustaining motivation to persist in job search and identify obstacles that are under one's control was considered a priority task for the intervention. Importantly, the prior study revealed that the abovementioned attitudes and associated behaviors were more pronounced for women and youth who face higher barriers to entry into the labor market in Turkey.

To address the identified skills constraints, the intervention drew on the social psychology literature. To support jobseekers in the generation of realistic job search goals and to improve their motivation in job search, the intervention targeted self-awareness, defined as the capacity to become the object of one's own attention (Duval & Wicklund 1972). For the intervention, improved self-awareness was expected to enable jobseekers to have a realistic perception of themselves and to imagine a future self,

⁷ Besides informing the design of the intervention, the prior study was also extremely helpful in informing the team about the feasibility of different delivery modes for the intervention. For example, before the prior study was conducted, the team considered using the job counseling sessions as the medium for the intervention; however, the prior study revealed that the job counseling sessions were too brief to include an intervention.

as well as to motivate them to change their unemployment situation, so that they can achieve their imagined future self. At the same time, by emphasizing a positive aspect of the self (through a self-affirmation exercise) participants' attentiveness to the intervention was expected to improve.

The intervention also targeted belief in change, also sometimes called “growth mindset,” or “implicit theories” (Dweck 2015). This as motivation is also related to notions of immutability of one's circumstances, which appears to influence the motivation and disposition of individuals to develop or acquire new skills and to exert effort (Dweck et al. 1995). A growth mindset was expected to enable the jobseeker to abandon the belief that his or her unemployed situation is permanent and acquire the positive expectation that his or her conditions can change, and that he or she can take an active role in this change. At the same time, these gains were expected to enhance perseverance and cultivate resilience (for example, through gratitude, positive reappraisal, and hope).

The intervention also provided jobseekers with goal-setting and goal attainment tools that can help them to move from wishing to doing, with goals defined as internal and subjective processes and states that motivate individuals to achieve them (Bargh et al. 2010). In other words, once equipped with the right mindsets to apply sustained effort in the pursuit of labor market (re)integration, participants were given practical tools and strategies to act on their enhanced motivation. Research by Gabriele Oettingen (summarized in Oettingen 2014) demonstrates the effectiveness of mental contrasting with implementation intentions (MCII), a metacognitive strategy for converting positive fantasies into self-regulated behavior change. MCII is commonly used for intervention purposes, and its effectiveness has been established in a variety of behaviors in educational, occupational and health domains. For example, Hagglund (2006) finds that job search support combined with monitoring of job search plans had positive effects in the likelihood of finding a job. The idea is that developing implementation intentions (Gollwitzer 1999)⁸ is a critical element of the goal intention or goal attainment. In fact, support was found for the proposed mediating role of implementation intentions in the relation between job search intention and job search behavior (van Hooft et al. 2005, Latham et al. 2005). Compared to the implementation intentions only, MCII supports a clearer elaboration of the desired goal by introducing the contrasting of fantasies about a desired future with reflections about obstacles that prevent their realization (Oettingen 2000, Duckworth et al. 2011). As jobseekers use the skills acquired in the intervention, over time, such “nudges” are expected to reinforce larger, more permanent changes especially through the responses they elicit in the environment, both structurally and socially, finally permanently altering person's core beliefs and construal of their self and the social world (Kenthirarajah & Walton 2015).

To address the observed unrealistic job search goals, the intervention also drew on the behavioral economics literature in providing user-friendly information to adjust expectations. The prior study revealed that many jobseekers did not incorporate their own qualifications or the local labor market

⁸ Implementation intentions are anticipated responses with goal-directed intentions in the form of the specific development of the when, where, and how a response or behavior will act in benefit of the goal attainment (Gollwitzer 1999).

context into their job search aspirations or expectations. This could be an example of judgmental overconfidence, caused by lack of timely and user-friendly information that could be relevant for the setting of job search goals. Excessively optimistic goals, both in regard to success rate in job search as well as the duration of the unemployment spell, could result in discouragement and lack of resilience when encountering rejection. On the other hand, excessively pessimistic assessment regarding job search could lead to disengagement from the goal of getting employed; indeed, for MCII to be an effective strategy, it has to rely on the setting of a feasible goal and the person's belief in the goal's attainability.⁹ Focusing on motivation as well as information, Altmann et al. (2015) test the effects of a brochure sent to German jobseekers containing information on issues likely to trigger a behavioral response by jobseekers. The brochures contained information on labor market conditions, unemployment duration, effects of unemployment on life satisfaction, role of social networks in finding a job and staying motivated. The intervention showed positive effects with those at risk of long-term unemployment about a year after receiving the brochure.

2.1 THE INTERVENTION DESIGN

The resulting intervention was designed based on the above literature, the insights obtained from the prior study on İŞKUR center infrastructure and capacity, as well as continuous consultation with İŞKUR on preferred methods to deliver trainings to jobseekers. The final pilot intervention consisted of two parts – an informational brochure (aka *Job Search Skills Primer*) and a socioemotional skills training (aka *SES Training*). Each of these is described in more detail below.

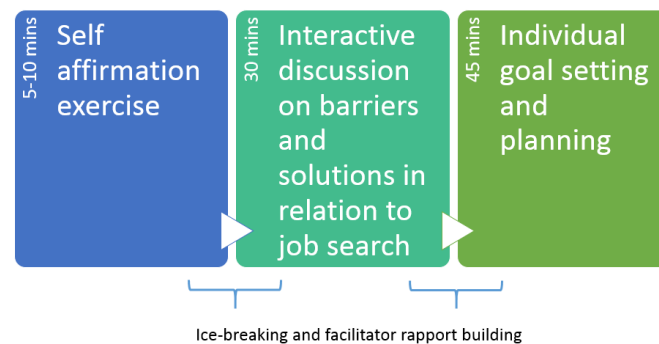
JSS Primer consisted of a brochure to be distributed to newly registered jobseekers. The main objective of the *JSS Primer* is to ensure that jobseekers have adequate and timely information to form and adjust their job search expectations (e.g. their expectations about the duration of the job search process), their job aspirations (e.g. their ideas about what types of jobs they intend to look for), and the expected returns to increased job search effort. In addition, the primer aims to raise awareness about İŞKUR services and provide basic job search tips. The *JSS Primer* was delivered to jobseekers in two formats: 1) printed four-page booklet was distributed to jobseekers who registered with İŞKUR by coming to an İŞKUR center in person; 2) online popup window with the brochure contents was delivered to jobseekers who registered with İŞKUR via the İŞKUR website. The *JSS Primer* contains facts on the Turkish labor market, including the number of new jobs created in Turkey in the previous year, with breakdowns by gender and age (less than 30 / 30+) and the average duration of an unemployment spell. The *JSS Primer* also emphasizes that job search effort increases the chances of finding a job, provides tips on how to look for work, and contains information on the number of local vacancies registered with İŞKUR. The last page includes 5 tips for effective job search, with messages such as “Be Determined” and “Be Resilient,” provides information on how many jobseekers were placed into

⁹ Interview with Gabriele Oettingen.

jobs by İŞKUR in the jobseeker's province and gives İŞKUR's contact information. The full brochure for Ankara, back-translated to English, is presented in Annex 1.

The objective of the *SES Training* is to equip jobseekers with sustained motivation for job search and to provide them with a metacognitive strategy – on planning and acting on plans – in order to influence their job search intensity and their persistence and resilience in the job search. The training consists of a single session of about 1.5 hours, delivered to groups of up to 15 newly registered jobseekers by a JVC trained to deliver *SES Training*. The session is divided into three modules: self-affirmation exercise, interactive discussion of job search barriers and solutions using case studies, and a step-by-step individual goal-setting and planning exercise modeled after the literature on MCII interventions (e.g. Gollwitzer et al. 2004, Oettingen and Gollwitzer 2010, Oettingen and Reininger 2016, Wittleder et al. 2018). Figure 3 below summarizes the main structure of the training session.

Figure 3: Socioemotional skills training main structure



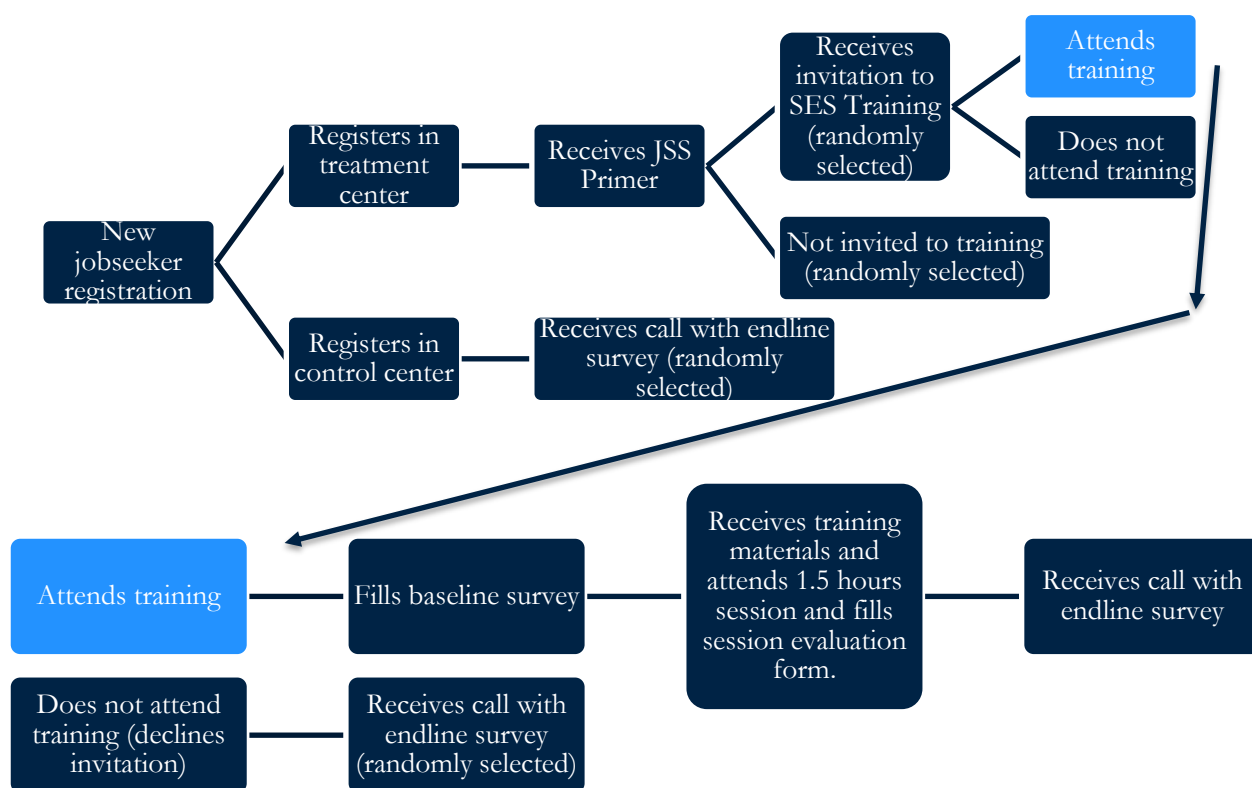
At the beginning of the session, participants are asked to fill a brief baseline survey. The facilitation of the session happens with a slide deck that is projected and used to guide the participants throughout the session. As part of the session, participants watch several short videos: a video on the power of a growth mindset (based on the example of London cab drivers who study the names of all the roads in London to pass the cab-driver exam), a video on the marshmallow test (based on Walter Mischel's seminal study of children learning different strategies for self-control, Mischel et al. 1989), and a video case study of two Turkish jobseekers, who face specific job search challenges and overcome his or her obstacles in order to get a job. Before the session, participants are provided with a workbook to record their responses to exercises conducted during the session; participants are asked to keep this workbook for their future use, as it contains additional blank pages that guide the jobseeker through the goal-setting and planning steps. All participants are asked to fill a session evaluation form at the end of the session.

2.2 THE INTERVENTION DELIVERY AND EVALUATION DESIGN

The pilot intervention that combined the *JSS Primer* and *SES Training* was implemented in five provinces of Turkey. As both parts of the intervention are intended to affect only the quality of labor supply and presume adequate local labor demand, the pilot focused on large urban centers in Turkey, which have more dynamic labor markets. On this basis and in consultation with government counterparts, the five provinces chosen for the pilot were Istanbul, Ankara, Bursa, Izmir, and Kocaeli. These provinces have 28 İŞKUR centers, not counting the Ankara İŞKUR headquarters office.¹⁰ For the purpose of the randomized controlled trial evaluation, the 28 İŞKUR centers in the five pilot provinces were first stratified by center size, based on their weekly flow of jobseekers (center size between 1 (smallest) and 7 (biggest)) and province; the 18 treatment centers were randomly selected within strata into the treatment group, while the others became controls (see Annex 2 for the list of treatment and control centers).

The intervention and evaluation steps are summarized in Figure 4 below:

Figure 4: Intervention and evaluation steps



¹⁰ The 28 centers represent about 22% of all İŞKUR centers in the country, as of February 2015.

Prior to the rollout of the intervention, the World Bank – İŞKUR team carried out a pre-test and trained JVCs to deliver the *SES Training* sessions. The pre-test covered the participants’ recruitment method, test of the intervention content and delivery of the *SES Training*. The pre-test was carried out in two centers of the Konya province (i.e. outside the five pilot provinces) in November 2017. Shortly before the intervention rollout in mid-April 2018, 96 JVCs from the 18 İŞKUR centers were trained by a team of professional İŞKUR trainers and World Bank team members on the content and delivery of the *SES Training*. The training was conducted separately in each province (with two training sessions in Istanbul, one in the Anatolian and one in the European side). During the training, the trainers went through the *SES Training* content, distributed the facilitator guidebook with step-by-step instructions on how to deliver the *SES Training*, including USBs with all presentations needed for conducting the sessions, and went over the logistical details, *inter alia*, the necessary equipment and materials for each session, the distribution, collection, and secure storage of baseline questionnaires and session evaluation forms, the printing out of the attendance sheets, the collecting the attendee signatures and the filling out of the session log.

The implementation of the intervention took place between April and October 2018 - the timeline of the study is delineated in Annex 3. For the duration of the intervention, both the *JSS Primer* and the *SES Training* were aimed at newly-registered jobseekers in the randomly-selected 18 İŞKUR centers. Within these populations, all jobseekers registering with İŞKUR as either “new labor market entrant” or “unemployed after having a job” – two registration status types that represent the vast majority of all new registrations in an average İŞKUR center – are included in the study.¹¹ The *JSS primer* was distributed to all the jobseekers mapped to the 18 treatment centers immediately after their registration with İŞKUR to ensure realistic expectations are set as early as possible in the job search spell.¹² *SES Training* sessions were delivered in the 18 İŞKUR centers by the trained JVCs to groups of up to 15 participants and were held each week until the last day of the pilot’s implementation.¹³ *SES Training* participants were recruited via one of the following two methods¹⁴:

¹¹ These registration status indicators are automatically recorded by İŞKUR at registration, and draw on the data from the Social Security Institution. The only excluded registration status types were “looking for a better job while currently being employed” and “looking for a job after retirement.” Using the monthly administrative data on registrations with İŞKUR in 2015 and 5 months of 2016, the average İŞKUR center in the 5 pilot provinces had 60% of registrations as “new labor market entrant,” 23% of registrations as “unemployed after having a job,” 17% of registrations as “looking for a better job while currently being employed,” and 0% of registrations as “looking for a job after retirement.” However, there is significant heterogeneity in these shares between the 28 İŞKUR centers and over time.

¹² As mentioned above, the *JSS Primer* was delivered through one of two methods: i) a printed copy given to those registering face-to-face in İŞKUR centers and ii) pop-up window for those registering online.

¹³ No trainings were held on public holidays that occurred during the implementation period.

¹⁴ Prior to the recruitment method described below, the team had experimented with two different invitation methods: 1) the “call-first” recruitment method, in which jobseekers were first invited via phone calls to the trainings and then sent a reminder SMS; this method proved impractical as most of the jobseekers were not

- 1) SMS-first invitations: An initial SMS was sent by İŞKUR through a system regularly used by the institution to contact registered jobseekers; this SMS was sent on the same day as the jobseeker registered in the İŞKUR system. The SMS invited jobseekers to participate in the training session (usually scheduled in the following 2-3 days). The SMS was followed by a phone call, made one day prior to the training, to obtain the RSVP (i.e. intention to attend the training) and answer any questions. While the SMS went out to all newly-registered jobseekers in treatment centers (18 centers in total), follow-up calls were conducted based on a randomized list of jobseekers who had received the SMS for a specific session until the capacity of the training venue plus extra 50% of participants was confirmed for each training session.
- 2) On-site invitations: Jobseekers who came to the İŞKUR center on the day of the scheduled training (about an hour before the training) to register with İŞKUR were invited on-site to participate in the training session.

There was close monitoring of the implementation of the intervention, particularly to monitor take-up and address the observed low take-up rate of the *SES Training* intervention. Throughout the duration of the intervention period, the World Bank and İŞKUR project team were in touch with the JVCs delivering the trainings in each of the 18 İŞKUR centers to ensure that they had the necessary materials and to answer any questions that arose during implementation. Using data from the recruitment process and the data collected from JVC facilitators of the *SES Training*, the World Bank team also provided frequent reports to the İŞKUR team on implementation progress, particularly on the number of sessions held by center and the take-up rates attained. In July 2018, a joint İŞKUR-World Bank team visited 9 of the 18 treatment centers to observe the *SES Training* sessions and hold focus group discussions with JVC facilitators. The findings of these consultation visits included challenges with low attendance for scheduled sessions and difficulties delivering sessions to heterogeneous groups of jobseekers. Based on these consultations, the team introduced low-powered incentives in the form of training completion certificates to jobseekers who complete the *SES Training* and used these certificates in the invitation process in order to address the take-up challenge.

By the end of the intervention period, the *SES Training* was delivered to 2,216 jobseekers. More than 500 *SES Training* sessions took place, with centers conducting an average of 28 sessions (although there was a significant range in the number of sessions conducted by each center – from 10 sessions in smaller centers like Beyoğlu and Gölcük to 56 sessions in a large center of Çankaya). The number of jobseekers participating in *SES Training* falls somewhat short of the estimate minimum ideal number to detect significant impacts of the intervention (which based on power calculations was estimated to

picking up the call, potentially because the number was unknown to them; then 2) the “SMS-first” recruitment method, i.e. the job seekers first received an SMS about the upcoming phone call and then they were called and invited for the training, was implemented on its own. Later, in order to increase the take-up rate, on-site invitations were added to “SMS-first” recruitment method.

be at least 2,476 participants completing the *SES Training*).¹⁵ ¹⁶ As mentioned earlier, the real challenge was the take-up rate. Out of 89,506 people called to participate in an *SES Training* session, only 55% were reached (49,315); and of these, only 21% confirmed participation.¹⁷ Of those who confirmed participation on the phone, only 21% actually showed up to the session (representing 4.5% of all who were reached or 2.5% of all who were called). However, the number of jobseekers attending training still allows for an impact analysis of the pilot.

3. DATA AND METHODOLOGY

3.1 DATA

In this study, two main data sources are used for the evaluation: administrative data and survey data. Administrative data are provided by İŞKUR based on the jobseeker profile database and İŞKUR services user database. This weekly data include all new İŞKUR registrants in both treatment and control centers, starting one week before the first *SES Training* session and continuing until six weeks after the last *SES Training* session date (i.e. two months after the last study participant registered with İŞKUR). Administrative data includes, *inter alia*, basic socio-demographics (age, gender, education level, years of work experience, occupation, disability), İŞKUR registration status, used to determine eligibility for the intervention (new labor market entrant, unemployed after having a job, looking for a better job while currently being employed, looking for a job after retirement), date of registration with İŞKUR, registration method (online, in center, used to determine the format of *JSS Primer* delivery), job location preferences, training certificates, skills, enrollment in and completion of İŞKUR programs, unemployment insurance/benefit receipt, participation in public works programs, application to jobs listed in the İŞKUR system and the result of this application.

In addition to the administrative data, an endline survey was administered via phone by a previously contracted survey firm. The survey is collected from jobseekers in both treatment and control centers

¹⁵ Power calculations are used to determine the probability of finding an effect in a given sample. In other words, assuming that the intervention has a significant effect on the outcomes of interest (such as the probability of finding a job), power calculations show the number of individuals that are needed to include in our sample to be able to see this effect.

¹⁶ Power calculations were based on the existing literature from labor market and psychology interventions. We used as parameters a control group mean employability probability of 0.420 (Hirshleifer et al. 2014; relevant population of jobseekers in Turkey), a standard deviation of 0.422 (Card et al. 2018; meta-analysis of labor market policies, subsample for job search assistance interventions) and a mean difference of 0.0503 between treatment and control groups (Card et al. 2018). Calculations were adjusted for clustering, with cluster size understood as the number of new unemployed registrants in each İŞKUR center per working day using the average daily inflow (workdays only) in the 28 participating centers between January 2016 and September 2017.

¹⁷ Each person was called up to three times before moving on to the next one on the list. Given that almost half of the potential attendees could not be reached, for most centers this procedure implied that the entire universe of registered jobseekers on the days prior to the training were called.

two months after they register with İŞKUR services.¹⁸ In particular, the endline survey targeted all jobseekers who completed the *SES Training* session. It also interviewed a random sample of jobseekers in training centers who had been reached with a recruitment phone call but who declined the invitation to the *SES Training* (i.e. non-compliers). Finally, the endline survey reached a randomly-selected sample of jobseekers from control centers.¹⁹ The survey includes a battery of questions on job search attitudes and activities, labor market outcomes since registration with İŞKUR, and socioemotional skills.²⁰ The endline survey started two months after the launch of intervention implementation (April 2018) and continued for six weeks after the last *SES Training* session date (i.e. mid-December 2018). Both the administrative data and endline survey aimed at following-up jobseekers at two months after their registration with İŞKUR.

The final evaluation sample consists of 3,994 jobseekers with 2,715 individuals in the treatment group (1,169 of whom attended the *SES Training* and 1,546 of whom were non-compliers), and 1,279 individuals in the control group. Table 1 shows the balance on individual characteristics across treatment and control groups. Given the endline survey sampling strategy of interviewing as many *SES Training* participants as possible, *SES Training* participants are oversampled²¹; in Table 1 and elsewhere in this study (except where noted), weights are used to adjust the proportion of *SES Training* participants to be proportional to the actual take-up rate. Except age, the mode of registration, and registration on Friday, observed characteristics are relatively balanced at 95% confidence level. In terms of imbalances, treatment group jobseekers are (i) about one year older, (ii) more likely to register with İŞKUR in person, and (iii) more likely to register with İŞKUR on a Friday. These imbalances imply that in all the analysis that follows, age, registration method, and the day of registration should be included as covariates.

¹⁸ In addition to the endline survey, a brief baseline survey was administered to the *SES Training* participants at the start of the training session. Due to challenges in matching the baseline surveys to other data sources, the results in this report are based on the administrative and endline survey data only.

¹⁹ The random selection of non-compliers and control center participants was done in such a way as to match the registration week of the treated participants, and the non-compliers were also matched on the same İŞKUR center as the treated participants.

²⁰ The endline survey included 10 items aimed to measure socio-emotional skills (see Annex 4 for the wording of the items) at the end of the survey (to avoid framing the rest of the responses). Items were measured on a 5-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree). Single items were used to measure growth mindset ($M = 2.95$, $SD = 1.19$), self-efficacy ($M = 3.44$, $SD = 1.02$), and self-evaluation ($M = 3.96$, $SD = 0.74$). Two items measured perceived control ($M = 3.27$, $SD = 0.7$) and positivity ($M = 3.93$, $SD = 0.63$), respectively. Finally, grit was measured by three items ($M = 3.76$, $SD = 0.56$). We followed the pre-analysis plan to create the index variables. To create the index variables for the SE constructs, first, reverse-coded items were recoded. Then, all items were converted into z-scores. Constructs measured by multiple items were created by averaging their constituent items.

²¹ Among the treated participants, the response rate to the endline survey was 56%, mostly due to interviewers' inability to reach the respondent despite multiple attempts rather than rejection of the interview.

Table 1: Balance Across Treatment and Control

		Control Mean (SD) (1)	Treatment Difference (SE) (2)
Age	3994	29.37 (9.85)	1.07*** (0.39)
Male	3994	0.57 (0.5)	-0.01 (0.02)
Unemployed while working	3994	0.61 (0.49)	0.01 (0.02)
First Time Jobseeker	3994	0.39 (0.49)	-0.01 (0.02)
In Person Registration	3994	0.55 (0.5)	0.21*** (0.02)
Primary education	3768	0.39 (0.49)	0.04* (0.02)
Secondary education	3768	0.33 (0.47)	-0.01 (0.02)
Two Year Degree education	3768	0.11 (0.32)	-0.02 (0.01)
Bachelor Degree education	3768	0.16 (0.37)	-0.02 (0.01)
Graduate Degree education	3768	0.00 (0.05)	0.01* (0.00)
İŞKUR registration on Monday	3994	0.22 (0.41)	0.05 (0.03)
İŞKUR registration on Tuesday	3994	0.19 (0.39)	-0.05* (0.03)
İŞKUR registration on Wednesday	3994	0.19 (0.39)	-0.04 (0.03)
İŞKUR registration on Thursday	3994	0.19 (0.39)	0.02 (0.03)
İŞKUR registration on Friday	3994	0.16 (0.37)	0.05** (0.03)

*, **, and *** indicate significance at the 10%, 5% and 1% levels respectively. In column (1), the mean of the respective variable and its standard deviation (in parentheses) are reported for the control centers. In column (2), coefficients on the treatment indicator from a weighted linear regression are reported and clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses.

3.2 EVALUATION METHODOLOGY

The first main interest of the impact evaluation lies in estimating the intention-to-treat effects of the intervention (ITT). The evaluation setup randomly assigns each of the 28 İŞKUR centers to either a treatment or a control group. Within treatment group centers, jobseekers should receive a *JSS Primer* and be offered participation in the *SES Training* intervention. In practice, the evaluation team cannot be certain if all the eligible jobseekers indeed received a *JSS Primer*, or if they did, if they looked at it.²² For *SES Training*, the situation is more complicated – out of all jobseekers reached with an invitation to the *SES Training*, some fraction take up the offer and complete the training, while the remaining fraction of jobseekers declines the offer. From a policy perspective, the first key evaluation parameter to investigate is therefore the ITT effect of making the intervention available in İŞKUR centers. That is, the analysis compares average jobseeker outcomes between the randomly-assigned treatment and control centers.

Specifically, the analysis uses the following main specification to measure the intervention effect for the set of relevant outcomes

$$(1) \quad Y_{ipc} = \alpha + \beta T_c + \gamma X_{ipc} + \delta Z_{pc} + \varepsilon_{ipc},$$

where Y_{ipc} denotes the outcome of interest for individual i in center c in province p , T_c is the binary treatment indicator capturing whether the offer of program participation was available in a given center or not, X is the vector of individual-level covariates, Z is the vector of center-level covariates and ε_i is the error term. Hence, β is the intent-to-treat effect of interest (or, in other words, the effect of offering the intervention).

For the *SES Training*, the implementation of the ITT estimation takes into account individual jobseeker and center-level characteristics, as well as the data generation process of the estimation sample. The empirical specification (1) includes individual-level characteristics because these can be expected to determine whether a given jobseeker takes up the offer of program participation or not. Covariates included in the regression comprise age, gender, whether the person is a first-time jobseeker, whether she has registered in person vs. online (a key factor for this evaluation setup and an observed source of imbalance), and a series of indicator variables for educational attainment. Moreover, the empirical analysis includes center-level covariates, such as center size categories and caseload per caseworker, as these can also be expected to influence program take-up decisions. In addition, as patterns of registration and program take-up vary by weekday, also the weekday of jobseeker registration is included. Finally, as overall take-up of the program offer was relatively low (see above), program takers were oversampled in the endline survey by a factor of approximately 10. Specifically, the sample ratio of takers vs. decliners in the treatment centers is 43.06% (1,169 out of

²² The closest to observing whether a jobseeker received the JSS primer was tracking whether online registrants clicked on the popup window, but even that might not mean that the content of the JSS Primer was read.

2,715 observations in the treatment group) vs. 56.94% (1,546 out of the 2,715 observations), while the population ratio is 7.25% to 92.75%. Corresponding weights are generated and specification (1) is implemented as a weighted linear regression. Notably, to measure the ITT for *JSS Primer*, the same specification is implemented as an unweighted linear regression, since all newly-registered jobseekers in treatment centers (SES Training takers and decliners) had the same probability of receiving the *JSS Primer* treatment.

Additional information on intervention effectiveness is provided by comparing takers and would-be takers in the treatment and control groups. Complementing the intention-to-treat analysis – i.e., answering the question about the effects of *offering* the program – and given this type of intervention, it is also of interest to look at the average treatment effect (ATT), i.e. the impacts of actual *exposure* of beneficiaries to the program. While this cannot be done with the *JSS Primer*, for *SES Training* this approach makes use of the information on who among the persons offered the program took up the offer and who of them did not. That is, the first step of the ATT analysis estimates a probability model within the treatment centers only (N=2,715), relating the indicator of take-up (where 1 equals participation in *SES Training* and 0 equals declining the offer to participate in *SES Training*) as the dependent variable to the set of individual- and center-level covariates described above. This analysis demonstrates that males, labor market entrants, and more highly educated jobseekers were more likely to take up the SES Training (see Annex 5 for the results of this estimation). In a second step, the coefficients from this probability model are used to predict take-up probabilities for all individuals in the control group centers (N=1,279). The specific top quantile of the resulting distribution of take-up probabilities that reflects the population take-up rate (7.25%) is then used to identify the would-be takers, i.e. those individuals in the control group that would be expected to take up the treatment, if it were offered to them.

The first ATT specification is therefore implemented as

$$(2) \quad Y_{ipc} = \alpha + \beta_{ATT} T_c + \gamma X_{ipc} + \delta Z_{pc} + \varepsilon_{ipc},$$

which reads essentially the same as equation (1), but restricts the sample – and thus the binary treatment indicator T_c – to distinguish between the treated defined as the actual takers in the treatment centers and their controls defined as the would-be takers in the control centers. Using the would-be takers in the control centers arguably answers the counterfactual relevant for the ATT of what would have happened – in terms of the outcomes – to actual takers if they had not participated in the program.

A second ATT specification is implemented as

$$(3) \quad Y_{ipc} = \alpha + \beta_1 T_c + \beta_2 K_c + \beta_3 T_c K_c + \gamma X_{ipc} + \delta Z_{pc} + \varepsilon_{ipc},$$

which also includes the actual decliners in the treatment centers and the would-be decliners in the control centers in a difference-in-difference setup.²³ That is, the binary indicator T_C continues to distinguish between treatment centers in which the program was offered and control centers in which it was not offered, and the indicator K_C distinguishes whether the person is a taker or a decliner within each group. The ATT of interest is the coefficient on the interaction of the two indicators, β_3 , and also takes into account any differences between actual and would-be decliners in treatment and control centers.

The empirical implementation of equations (1), (2), and (3) implies that a fairly comprehensive set of hypotheses is being tested, as delineated above. These hypotheses are grouped into outcome domains. Within each domain, we adjust the respective p-values for the treatment effect coefficient using the Romano-Wolf stepdown procedure correcting for multiple hypothesis testing (Romano and Wolf 2005). For each regression, 1,000 bootstrap replications are used. Finally, standard errors are clustered at the center and day level, and all analysis includes province fixed effects.

4 RESULTS

This section presents the results of the analysis that tested several hypotheses relating to the impact of the intervention (consisting of *JSS Primer and SES Training*) on different outcomes.²⁴ Specifically, it was hypothesized that the intervention would have a positive impact on socioemotional skills, job search activities, and labor market outcomes of jobseekers. Besides measuring the average effects, the analysis explores effect heterogeneity by gender and age, hypothesizing that the improvements in socio-emotional skills induced by the intervention are expected to be quantitatively larger among population sub-groups that are at a relative disadvantage in the labor market, particularly, in the context of Turkey, women and youth. The literature on socio-emotional skills interventions suggests that these interventions (such as those instilling growth mindsets or countering stereotype threat) are more powerful for those who face higher initial disadvantage (Yeager and Walton 2011). Given the low female labor force participation in Turkey and the prevailing social norms about female employment, female jobseekers are more likely to face additional challenges in sustaining effort and motivation in their job search, which is addressed through the *SES Training*. There is also evidence from the literature on other Active Labor Market Policies that female participants may benefit more (Card et al. 2018). For the case of young jobseekers, the expectation was that the *SES Training* would boost their resilience to setbacks, which they are more likely to face during job search compared to more experienced jobseekers.

²³ Compares the mean change in the intervention and control groups

²⁴ The pre-analysis plan for this study was registered with the AEA RCT Registry (AEARCTR-0002869); <https://www.socialscienceregistry.org/trials/2869>.

Below the results are presented first for the ITT analysis for both *SES Training* and *JSS Primer*; this is followed by a discussion of the results for ATT for *SES Training*, i.e. the expected effects for those who take up the *SES Training* if this intervention is scaled up.

4.1 IMPACT OF OFFERING THE INTERVENTION: ITT ESTIMATION RESULTS FOR *SES TRAINING* AND *JSS PRIMER*

The analysis examined the impact of the *SES Training* and the *JSS Primer* on socioemotional skills, job search intensity, take-up of İŞKUR and non- İŞKUR ALMP services, employability, probability of employment, job-related characteristics, as well as the take-up and level of unemployment insurance.

Of the above, for the *SES Training*, of all the outcomes examined, only one (take-up of İŞKUR's Job Search Skills course) was found to be significantly affected (see Table 2).²⁵ In particular, jobseekers in treatment centers are 3 percentage points more likely to participate in the Job Search Skills course offered by İŞKUR. Such lack of ITT impacts for *SES Training* is not surprising, given the extremely low take-up of *SES Training*, which implies that *SES Training* participants are swamped by the much larger share of non-compliers in our weighted linear ITT model.

For those who were successful in having secured a job at the time of the endline survey, *SES Training* also appears to have had a heterogeneous age effect on the probability of being formally (versus informally) employed, proxied by employment's registration with the Social Security Institution (SSI) (see Table 3, column 2). Plotting the predicted probabilities of having a formal job separately for younger and older jobseekers in control and treatment groups actually reveals the opposite effect of treatment on job formality for younger (under 30) and older jobseekers: while the young in the treatment group are marginally more likely to work in formal (vs informal) jobs, the reverse is true for the older jobseekers (Figure 5).²⁶

Table 2: ITT estimates for the impact of *SES Training* on İŞKUR ALMP Services

²⁵ Null results were obtained in the analysis of the ITT impacts of *SES Training* for all socioemotional skills (self-efficacy for job search behavior, grit, perceived control over job search, positivity, growth mindset, core self-evaluation and resilience to setbacks), for job search intensity (the number of jobs applied to per week, the number of job search channels utilized), for take-up of İŞKUR services (vocational training, vacancy website, Job Counselling sessions, on-the-job training, entrepreneurship training), non- İŞKUR services (personal development course, online training course), for employability (job search breadth, level of reservation wage, willingness to move, learn new skills, change working conditions, reduce reservation wage, work on CV, work on interview skills), for probability of employment (indicator of attaining employment and duration of registered unemployment spell), for job-related characteristics (employment type, formality, contract type, labor earnings, overall job satisfaction, work conditions), and for unemployment insurance (take-up and level) variables.

²⁶ No other gender or age heterogeneity was found with respect to the ITT impacts of the *SES Training*.

	Job search skills course	Vocational training course	İŞKUR Website service use	JVC meetin g	On-the-Job training course	Entrepreneurs hip training
Treatme nt	0.028 (0.005) [0.000]	-0.012 (0.008) [0.431]	-0.034 (0.015) [0.109]	-0.001 (0.013) [0.941]	0.002 (0.009) [0.941]	-0.007 (0.007) [0.685]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

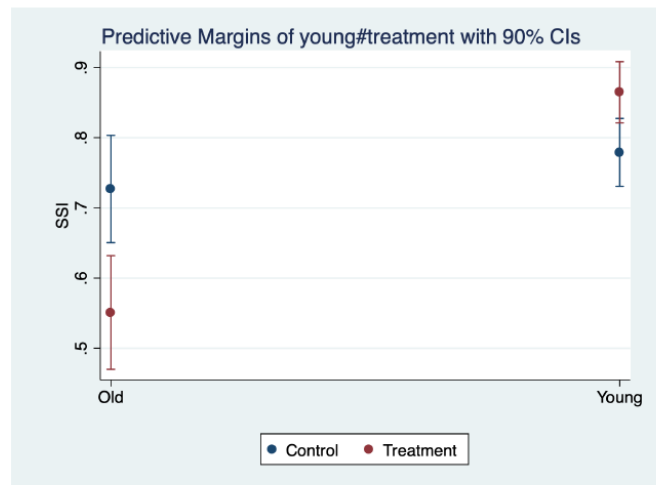
ITT coefficients from a weighted linear regression are reported. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. Clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates, job center-level and province-level characteristics.

Table 3: ITT estimates for the impact of SES Training on Job-related characteristics, treatment heterogeneous effects by age

	Self-employed vs. Wage-employed	Registered with SSI	Contract	Temp. Contract	Total Net Salary	Total Net Salary in Intervals	Commute	Days Worked	Hours Worked
Young* Treatment	-0.135 (0.049) [0.047]	0.262 (0.055) [0.000]	-0.003 (0.068) [0.991]	-0.02 (0.116) [0.991]	101.241 (102.846) [0.893]	0.483 (0.261) [0.341]	-2.956 (3.51) [0.904]	0.087 (0.154) [0.976]	0.098 (0.281) [0.991]
Observations	1358	1358	1051	468	1664	1723	1358	1358	1358

ITT coefficients from a linear regression are reported. Clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates, jobcenter-level and province-level characteristics.

Figure 5: Heterogeneous ITT effects for the impact of SES Training on Formality of Employment, by Age



Note: This figure plots the predictive values for SSI registry with confidence intervals at the 90% level by treatment status and age dummy based on the linear regression results in Table 3, column 2.

On the other hand, the *JSS Primer* had a significant and positive effect on the take-up of almost all İŞKUR ALMP services.²⁷ Table 4 shows the results. Jobseekers in treatment centers are 19 percentage points more likely to participate in the Job Search Skills course, 2 percentage points more likely participate in Vocational Training courses, and 6 percentage points more likely to attend meetings with JVCs (i.e. job counselling sessions). Moreover, jobseekers are 4 percentage points more likely to attend an On-the-Job Training and 3 percentage points more likely to attend an entrepreneurship skills training. Given that brochures are a relatively low-cost intervention, this result is encouraging and suggests that when information is provided in a timely and user-friendly manner, jobseekers are more likely to take up intermediation and training services that could be important for their job search.

²⁷ Null results were obtained in the analysis of the ITT impacts of the *JSS Primer* for all socioemotional skills, job search intensity, non-İŞKUR services, employability, probability of employment, job-related characteristics, and unemployment insurance variables.

Table 4: ITT estimates for the impact of JSS Primer on İŞKUR ALMP Services on İŞKUR ALMP Services

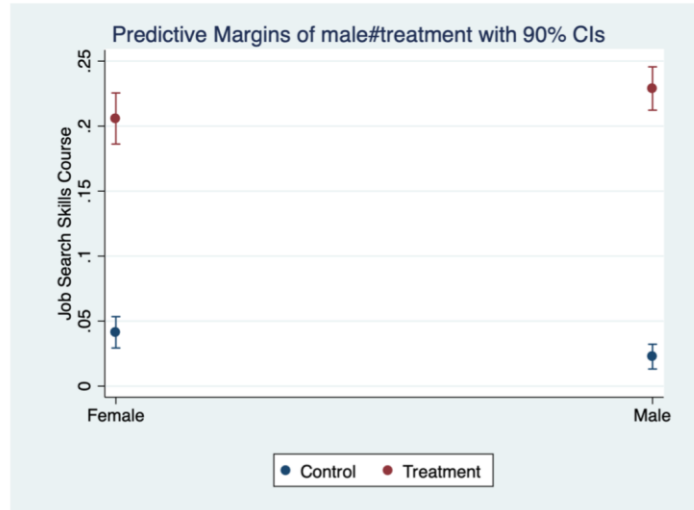
	Job search skills course	Vocational training course	İŞKUR Website service use	JVC meeting	On-the-Job training course	Entrepreneurship training
Treatment	0.188 (0.009) [0.000]	0.02 (0.009) [0.035]	-0.007 (0.014) [0.623]	0.062 (0.013) [0.000]	0.041 (0.009) [0.000]	0.033 (0.008) [0.000]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

Table reports ITT coefficients from a linear regression. Clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates, job center-level and province-level characteristics.

For the take-up of Job Search Skills training, the ITT effects exhibit gender and age heterogeneity, with higher impacts on males and jobseekers aged 30 and above (see Annex 6, Table A6.1 and Table A6.2). The gender heterogeneity is depicted in Figure 6, where the predicted probabilities of take-up for the Job Search Skills course are plotted separately for males and females in control and treatment groups. This figure clearly shows a positive treatment effect for both sexes, but a much bigger impact for men. The age heterogeneity results for Job Search Skills and Entrepreneurship Training are depicted in Figure 7, where the impacts are plotted separately for youth (under 30 years) and older jobseekers: while for Job Search Skills course, there is a significant positive ITT effect for both younger and older jobseekers albeit a bigger one for those aged 30+, for entrepreneurship training, the observed overall ITT effect is coming only from older jobseekers as there is no significant increase in take-up of this training by younger jobseekers.²⁸

²⁸ No other gender or age heterogeneity was found with respect to the ITT impacts of the *JSS Primer*.

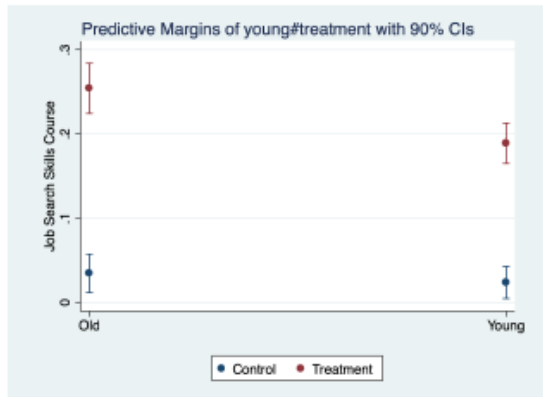
Figure 6: Heterogeneous ITT effects for the impact of JSS Primer on take-up of Job Search Skills Course, by Gender



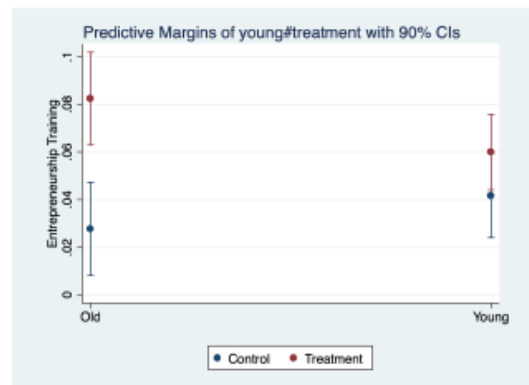
Note: This figure plots the predictive values for job search skills course take-up with confidence intervals at the 90% level by treatment status and gender dummy based on the linear regression results in Table A4.1, column 1.

Figure 7: Heterogeneous ITT effects for the impact of JSS Primer on take-up of Job Search Skills Course and Entrepreneurship Training, by Age

(A) Job Search Skills Course



(B) Entrepreneurship Training



Note: Figures in Panel A and Panel B plot the predictive values for job search skills course take-up and entrepreneurship training take-up with confidence intervals at the 90% level by treatment status and age dummy based on the linear regression results in Table A4.2, column 1 and column 6 respectively.

4.2 IMPACT OF PARTICIPATING IN THE INTERVENTION (ATT): ESTIMATION RESULTS FOR SES TRAINING

This section presents treatment effect estimation results for the average treatment effect (ATT) specifications for the *SES Training*, or the impact of exposure to the intervention. In particular, results from two specifications will be reported, the ATT comparing takers in the treatment group and would-be takers in the control group (see equation (2) in the methodology section) and the ATT using a difference-in-difference setup of takers vs. decliners in treatment vs. control centers (equation (3) above). Results are grouped by outcome domain and are reported in Tables 6 through 12 in this section. Heterogeneous results by gender and age are discussed in addition (but generally not presented in separate tables unless of particular noteworthiness, in order to keep the presentation succinct).

Participation in the treatment significantly decreases participants' short-term employment probability, but significantly increases their active search probability. As Table 5 illustrates, there is a statistically significant negative treatment effect on the employment probability comparing takers in the treatment group with their (would-be taker) controls. At the same time, there is a large and statistically significant treatment effect on the probability of active search, and no significant changes in the probabilities of being in education or training, or having stopped to look for a job. The outcomes reported here are from the endline survey data and mutually exclusive; that is, they indicate that the treatment induces participants to continue actively searching for a job at the expense of moving into employment in the short-run.

Stratifying these results by gender (not shown in the table) indicates that this pattern is mainly driven by male jobseekers – for female jobseekers, all four point estimates are not statistically different from zero. In addition, looking specifically at younger jobseekers (29 years of age or younger; results not shown in the table), the point estimates for all four outcomes are similar in magnitude, but none of them is statistically significant at conventional levels. Looking specifically at older jobseekers (30 years of age or older), again the point estimates are of similar magnitude. However, the two estimates for the outcomes “Searching” and “Quit looking” are statistically significant: that is, due to the intervention adult jobseekers are more likely to be actively searching, and are less likely to have quit looking for a job.

Table 5: *ATT effects on labor forces status (survey data)*

	Employed	Searching	Education or Training	Quit looking
Treatment	-0.188 (0.059) [0.004]	0.238 (0.057) [0.]	-0.004 (0.016) [0.406]	-0.046 (0.038) [0.803]
N	1262	1262	1262	1262
Treatment * Taker	-0.13 (0.053) [0.043]	0.219 (0.056) [0.002]	-0.017 (0.019) [0.199]	-0.071 (0.044) [0.346]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994

Note: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and job center-level characteristics.

In terms of the potential channels that bring about the observed effects on active job search, the treatment induces a significant positive effect on the self-reported measure of growth mindset – but other socioemotional skills are not measurably affected.²⁹ ATT estimates on socioemotional skills are reported in Tables 6 and 7. Overall, most outcomes are not significantly influenced by the treatment. There is, however, a statistically significant treatment effect on the growth mindset throughout, indicating that the treatment does achieve its aim of broadening the mindset of the participants and make them more open for their labor market search efforts and arising opportunities. The estimated effect is also quite large in size. Distinguishing male and female participants (not shown in the table) does not change the overall pattern. Only one thing is notable: The second construct of “perceived control” in Table 8 shows a significantly negative effect in the difference-in-differences (DiD) specification, giving a slight indication that this may not be positively influenced by the treatment – this effect is driven by the female subpopulation only, for males the respective coefficient is insignificant. Finally, as for the overall population, also for young jobseekers the socioemotional skills dimension are not measurably affected.

²⁹ While self-reported measures can have disadvantages in terms of measurement of impact for interventions explicitly targeting measured constructs, in the particular case of this intervention the delivery of the growth mindset messages was conducted via a very short video presented within a case study of London cab drivers and self-reports were collected two months after the intervention, making biased self-reports more unlikely.

Table 6: *ATT effects on SES module - Construct 1*

	Self-Efficacy	Grit	Perceived Control	Positivity	Growth Mindset	Self-evaluation
Treatment	-0.155 (0.108) [0.446]	0.051 (0.127) [0.888]	-0.042 (0.12) [0.888]	0.102 (0.125) [0.779]	0.242 (0.105) [0.099]	0.242 (0.153) [0.405]
N	1262	1262	1262	1262	1262	1262
Treatment * Taker	0.214 (0.112) [0.228]	-0.077 (0.103) [0.76]	-0.052 (0.118) [0.76]	0.098 (0.121) [0.76]	0.223 (0.105) [0.161]	0.163 (0.134) [0.58]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

Table 7: *ATT effects on SES Module - Construct 2*

	Grit	Perceived Control	Positivity	Growth Mindset
Treatment	0.143 (0.125) [0.268]	-0.24 (0.12) [0.126]	0.201 (0.142) [0.242]	0.242 (0.105) [0.078]
N	1262	1262	1262	1262
Treatment * Taker	0.032 (0.109) [0.792]	-0.265 (0.113) [0.065]	0.153 (0.128) [0.38]	0.223 (0.105) [0.088]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994

Note for tables 6 and 7: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and jobcenter-level characteristics.

The outcome domain “Resilience to setbacks” does not indicate significant improvements. Table 8 reports ATT estimates for a series of outcomes comprising dimensions of resilience to setbacks. The results for this domain do not indicate measurable changes in outcomes between the takers in the treatment and the takers in the control group. This is also the case for any stratification by gender or age.

Table 8. *ATT effects on Resilience to setbacks*

	Job offer ratio	Job offer ratio (admin)	Rejected indicator	Rejected ind. (admin)	Continue after rejection
Treatment	-0.145 (0.06) [0.079]	0.063 (0.061) [0.631]	-0.022 (0.076) [0.74]	-0.117 (0.082) [0.426]	-0.103 (0.133) [0.665]
N	562	273	713	273	224
Treatment * Taker	-0.088 (0.054) [0.349]	-0.204 (0.101) [0.188]	0.01 (0.074) [0.926]	0.176 (0.116) [0.349]	-0.054 (0.145) [0.926]
N	1546	817	1931	817	551

Note: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and jobcenter-level characteristics.

Job search channels are considerably intensified and broadened – and the number of job applications stays constant for males, but increases significantly for females and for youths. Table 9 shows a substantial and statistically significant increase in the use of job search channels (column 3). These treatment effects are measurable for both male and female jobseekers. In addition, looking at application behavior, there is also a large and statistically significant treatment effect on the number of job applications per week for females, as illustrated in Table 10 (column 1) for both ATT specifications. This treatment effect is not significant for males (not shown). Also for the subsample of younger jobseekers the DiD specification finds a significant treatment effect on the number of weekly job applications (not shown in the table); for the first ATT specification the coefficient is of the same magnitude, but not significantly different from zero. For older (age 30+) workers, while the point estimates on the number of job applications are not significantly different from zero, there is a highly significant increase in the number of search channels.

Table 9: *ATT effects on job search intensity – males only*

	Weekly applied jobs (IUS)	Weekly applied jobs (CUS)	Search channels
Treatment	-0.207 (0.381) [0.588]	0.636 (0.075) [0.587]	0.282 (0.102) [0.029]
N	280	713	1262
Treatment * Taker	0.054 (1.506) [0.964]	-0.491 (1.278) [0.917]	0.277 (0.098) [0.025]
N	986	1931	3993

Note: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and job center-level characteristics.

Table 10: *ATT effects on job search intensity - females only*

	Weekly applied jobs (IUS)	Weekly applied jobs (CUS)	Search channels
Treatment	4.57 (1.598) [0.037]	0.092 (2.459) [0.968]	0.414 (0.215) [0.095]
N	112	241	430
Treatment * Taker	4.88 (2.057) [0.045]	-3.783 (5.373) [0.542]	0.459 (0.183) [0.042]
N	501	732	1681

Note: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and job center-level characteristics.

There are large and statistically significant treatment effects on the take-up of a whole set of İŞKUR ALMP services. Table 11 presents ATT estimates for the probability of taking up ALMPs offered by İŞKUR. With the exception of İŞKUR website, there is a significant treatment effect on the take up probability of all other İŞKUR ALMP offers. Treatment effects are particularly large for the immediate job search ALMP services, such as the Job Search Skills course (first column) and the JVC meeting (fourth column), but also statistically significant for the three different types of training programs.

These overall results hold equally for male and female jobseekers (not shown in the table). For younger jobseekers, there are significant and large treatment effects for the take-up of Job Search Skills training (both ATT specifications) and for the take-up of on-the-job training (DiD specification). For the other ALMP services, ATT coefficient for youths are similar in size as for the full sample, but not significant at conventional levels. Regarding older jobseekers, again the overall results apply: there are significant and large increases in the uptake of all types of İŞKUR courses with the exception of the website use.

Table 11: ATT effects on İŞKUR ALMP services

	Job search skills course	Vocational training course	İŞKUR Website service use	JVC meeting	On-the-Job training course	Entrepreneurship training
Treatment	0.49 (0.025) [0.]	0.068 (0.025) [0.017]	-0.018 (0.054) [0.71]	0.177 (0.043) [0.]	0.08 (0.029) [0.017]	0.093 (0.024) [0.001]
N	1262	1262	1262	1262	1262	1262
Treatment * Taker	0.509 (0.019) [0.]	0.101 (0.025) [0.]	0.075 (0.047) [0.102]	0.18 (0.043) [0.]	0.119 (0.024) [0.]	0.136 (0.022) [0.]
N	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

Note: Table entries in the upper panel are ATT coefficients from a weighted linear regression comparing the actual takers within the group assigned to treatment with the predicted would-be takers in the control group. The weights reflect that actual takers are oversampled in the treatment group. The second panel reports ATT coefficients from a difference-in-difference specification interacting treatment with take-up. In both panels, clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates and jobcenter-level characteristics.

In addition to the outcome domains reported here, treatment effects were also estimated for outcome domains covering Non-İŞKUR ALMP services, job characteristics, CV preparation, labor market expectations (such as lowest acceptable salary), and unemployment insurance take-up. No significant or otherwise noteworthy results are found for these outcome domains, such that they are not further

reported here. Moreover, for many of these outcomes only small subsamples are available, further impeding the interpretability of the estimation results.

5 CONCLUSIONS AND LESSONS LEARNED

This study examined the impact of an intervention that delivered timely and relevant information and socioemotional skills training to newly-registered jobseekers in Turkey. Main results of this study are as follows:

- The *offer* of *SES Training* (as analyzed using ITT estimation) is not expected to bring about major impacts, at least in part due to very low observed take-up rate. However, *exposure* to this training (as analyzed using ATT estimation) has positive and significant – and also large – effects in particular on job search behavior and take-up of İŞKUR ALMP services.
- The impacts observed after the exposure to *SES training* can also have a positive follow-on effect on longer-term labor market outcomes.
 - One key mechanism seems to be a shift in the overall labor market activity towards job search. For the male participants, this shift seems to come at the expense of dismissing short-term employment opportunities for investing in job search (see Table 6). The shift towards an increased search intensity is reflected in the significantly increased use of job search channels for both genders, and also, for female jobseekers, in the immediate rise in job applications per week.
 - In addition, treated jobseekers experience significant and sizable increase in the take-up of İŞKUR ALMP services, ranging from the more immediate job search programs – job search skills course, JVC meetings – to a range of longer-term investments in skills (such as vocational training or entrepreneurship training). Estimated treatment effects for young jobseekers display the same general pattern – positive effect on job search efforts and ALMP services take-up – but are overall somewhat less pronounced. These results, along with the measurable increase in individual participants’ growth mindset, indicate that the program broadens participants’ perspectives on the labor market and leads them to make increased investments into their future – through more intensive job search efforts – that are likely, in the case of ALMP skills-building services, to pay off also in the longer run.
- With regard to the provision of timely and relevant information on the local labor market, expected returns to job search effort, and the available İŞKUR services, the ITT estimation found significant positive impacts of offering the *JSS Primer* upon registration on the take-up of İŞKUR ALMP services, particularly for men and older jobseekers, and on utilization of more varied job search channels. Given these significant positive impacts and the relatively low cost of printing

and distributing the *JSS Primer*, one recommendation of this study is to *scale up the JSS Primer distribution to all newly-registered İŞKUR jobseekers*.³⁰

As for the future of *SES Training*, if this intervention is to be implemented on a larger scale in Turkey, two challenges observed during the pilot implementation would need to be addressed:

- Increasing the take-up rate: As described in the study, low take-up rate of the *SES Training* by jobseekers was the central implementation challenge. This occurred despite the training being a one-time commitment of 1.5 hours on the part of jobseekers.³¹ One recommendation that could be considered if the objective is to increase exposure to the *SES Training* is *to use a higher-powered incentive*. The pilot implementation introduced a low-powered incentive (completion certificate) midway through the implementation period to address the observed low take-up. This incentive seemed to help somewhat but introduction of a higher-powered incentive (like the supermarket voucher or mobile phone credit, considered by the team, or a transport or per diem subsidy) could be more adequate motivator to increase exposure to the intervention and reduce the selection of takers into this training. Another possibility is to *provide information on the impacts observed from the pilot (e.g. higher likelihood of a formal job for youth, and greater job search intensity for women) during the recruitment process*.
- Improve the tailoring of the *SES Training* to different types of jobseekers: If the low take-up rate can be addressed, the next challenge to increase the effectiveness of the *SES Training* is to *create more homogeneous training groups (for example, by jobseekers' age, education, and/or years of work experience)* to improve tailoring of the training and enhance the quality of discussion among group participants. This could be done using the information available in the İŞKUR registration database. In large urban centers with several İŞKUR centers, jobseekers with similar profiles but registered at different İŞKUR centers could be invited to attend a joint SES Training session.
- Consider increasing intervention intensity: Interventions, particularly those for out-of-school populations, always face tradeoffs between intensity and scalability. With this in mind, the current *SES Training* intervention, consisting of a single 1.5 hour session, was designed to ensure scalability under İŞKUR's operational constraints. Future interventions could be more intensive, with either follow-on sessions -for example, a check-in with a JVC on how goal setting and planning has been working for the jobseeker, or reminders of the learned skills -for example, SMS or similar suggesting to continue the job search even in the face of setbacks. These additions could add

³⁰ Importantly, the time-varying information on the local labor market and İŞKUR placement rates needs to be monitored and regularly updated to maintain credibility of the information contained in the *JSS Primer*.

³¹ One possible interpretation of the low take-up rate is that job search in Turkey relies more heavily on social networks and informal references to find a job over a more structured formal process of job search and application. Even in that scenario, the intervention can potentially benefit those with poor social networks (or the all-important “weak ties” that help with job search, as per Granovetter 1977), which in the Turkish labor market would most likely include women and youth.

salience to the training content and lessons, and permit jobseekers to practice the skills they learned during the session.

The results of this study are of interest beyond Turkey, as they contribute to filling a knowledge gap on the application of insights from behavioral economics and social psychology to increase the effectiveness of labor market training and employment services in developing countries.

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ANNEXES

Annex 1. JSS Primer (Ankara version)

READY TO LOOK FOR A JOB?



Take action to find the job you would like to have!



www.iskur.gov.tr

YOU COULD ALSO HAVE A JOB



Did you know that in Turkey, more than 1 million job seekers found a job last year?

Just last year, the number of workers rose from 27.2 million to 28.6 million, that is, almost 1,400,000 new jobs were created in Turkey.

The average job seeker took 4 months to get a job and many found a job within 2 months of starting to search.

SOURCE: Turkish Statistics Agency (Türktat) website, current date (October 2017). Household Labor Survey, 2016.

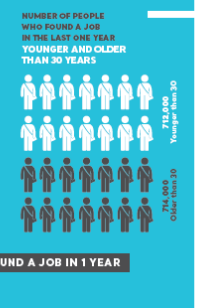
IT IS EASIER TO FIND A JOB WITH İSKUR!

NUMBER OF PEOPLE WHO FOUND A JOB IN THE LAST ONE YEAR MEN AND WOMEN



1,444,000 men
1,044,000 women

NUMBER OF PEOPLE WHO FOUND A JOB IN THE LAST ONE YEAR YOUNGER AND OLDER THAN 30 YEARS



778,000 Younger than 30
666,000 Older than 30

1.4 MILLION PEOPLE FOUND A JOB IN 1 YEAR

YOUR JOB SEARCH EFFORT WILL PAY OFF. ISKUR IS HERE TO HELP YOU

Keep Looking!

True, it can take time to find a job, sometimes several months. But studies show that with every month of **ACTIVE** job search the chances of finding a job improve. **SUSTAINED** effort and **SMART** searches are the key to success.

Where to look?

Remember! Everyday counts and **THERE ARE MANY WAYS TO LOOK FOR WORK**. You can search and apply for jobs here:

through ISKUR private employment agencies internet newspapers relative & friends

How to look?

You can increase your chances to find a job by looking for it through multiple channels. ISKUR can show you how to **SEARCH SUCCESSFULLY** with its Job Search Skills Training and materials. Just Ask your JVC!

ISKUR IS HERE TO HELP YOU!

In 2017, while there were more than 2.5 million vacant positions registered with ISKUR the number of vacant positions in Ankara alone was approximately **150,000**, covering a wide variety of skills levels and occupations ranging from sales representatives to technicians; and from technicians to experts.

5 TIPS FOR AN EFFECTIVE JOB SEARCH

- ✓ **BE DETERMINED** Define your goals and plan your job search step by step. If a job opportunity arises, take it.
- ✓ **BE FLEXIBLE** Don't hesitate to apply for a job just because it's not a perfect fit.
- ✓ **BE PROACTIVE** Focus on things you can do to improve your chances: maybe send out more applications or learn new skills.
- ✓ **BE RESILIENT** It may happen that you are not offered the job that you wanted. This is a normal part of the job search, don't take it personally. Keep trying with the next opportunity.
- ✓ **BE PATIENT** Job search takes time. Don't get discouraged, keep at it.

ISKUR helped place 69,057 job seekers into jobs in Ankara in 2017.

You, too, can have a suitable job with an effective job search process.

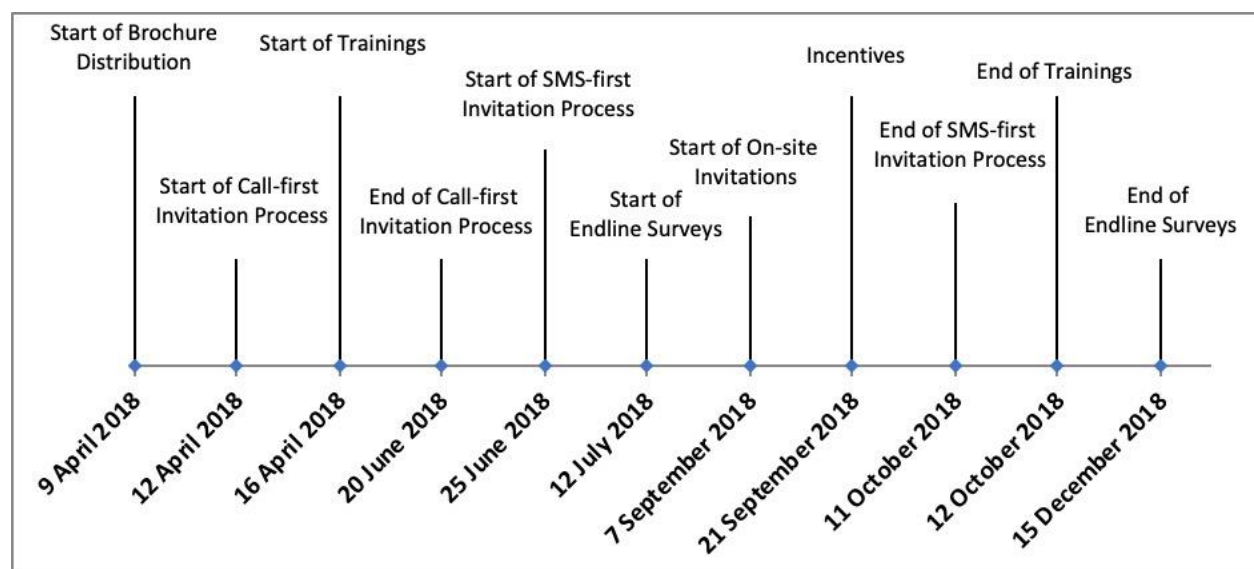
facebook.com/TurkiyelsKurumu @TurkiyelsKurumu 170 Call Center

For more information: www.iskur.gov.tr

Annex 2: Randomization at the Center level

Province	Center	Center Size	Control or Treatment
ANKARA	Polatli	1	Control
KOCAELI	Dilovasi	1	Control
KOCAELI	Gebze	2	Control
ISTANBUL	Sancaktepe	3	Control
IZMIR	Cigli	4	Control
IZMIR	Bornova	4	Control
ISTANBUL	Umraniye	5	Control
ISTANBUL	Buyukcekmece	6	Control
ANKARA	Altindag	7	Control
BURSA	Bursa	7	Control
BURSA	Gemlik	1	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Tuzla	1	Treatment
BURSA	Inegol	2	Treatment
IZMIR	Torbali	2	Treatment
KOCAELI	Golcuk	2	Treatment
ANKARA	Ostim	3	Treatment
IZMIR	Konak	3	Treatment
KOCAELI	Kocaeli	3	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Basaksehir	4	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Sisli	4	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Beyoglu	5	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Kadikoy	5	Treatment
IZMIR	Karabaglar	5	Treatment
ANKARA	Sincan	6	Treatment
ANKARA	Cankaya	6	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Pendik	6	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Bahcelievler	7	Treatment
ISTANBUL	Bayrampasa	7	Treatment

Annex 3: Timeline of project activities



Annex 4: Socioemotional Skills Items used in the endline survey

	I definitely do not agree	I do not agree	Not sure	I agree	I definitely agree
1. Overall, I don't expect to be very good at job search	1	2	3	4	5
2. What I do shapes my life.	1	2	3	4	5
3. Finding a good job depends on things I cannot control	1	2	3	4	5
4. I believe that my future will work out.	1	2	3	4	5
5. I am confident that I will be able to find the job I will really want in the near future	1	2	3	4	5
6. Setbacks discourage me.	1	2	3	4	5
7. I finish whatever I begin	1	2	3	4	5
8. I have important goals for my life	1	2	3	4	5
9. You have a certain amount of intelligence and you really can't do much to change it	1	2	3	4	5
10. I am confident I get the success I deserve in life.	1	2	3	4	5

Annex 5: ATT First Stage Results

Table A5.1 shows the first stage ATT results, in which a probit model for actual participation is estimated using the participation status (participated and declined) within the treatment group (including both compliers and non-compliers). The results show that significant drivers of take-up were (i) being male, (ii) being a first-time jobseeker and (iii) being highly educated.

Table A5.1 ATT First Stage Results

	Participated
Caseload	0.000 (0.000)
Age	0.205 (0.017)
Age Squared	0.000 (0.000)
Male	0.220*** (0.055)
First Time Jobseeker	0.218*** (0.055)
In person Registration	0.083 (0.067)
Secondary (No missing)	0.050 (0.067)
Associate (No missing)	0.289*** (0.098)
Bachelor (No Missing)	0.470*** (0.080)
Graduate (No Missing)	0.189 (0.293)
Education Missing	-0.408*** (0.137)
Observations	2715

This table produces the first stage ATT results by estimating a probit model using treatment group. Standard errors are reported in parentheses (). This regression also includes controls for weekdayXprovince and jobcenter-level characteristics.

Annex 6: Additional ITT tables and figures

Table A6.1 ITT estimates for the impact of JSS Primer on İŞKUR ALMP Services, heterogeneous treatment effects by gender

	Job search skills course	Vocational training course	İŞKUR Website service use	JVC meeting	On-the-Job training course	Entrepreneur ship training
Male*	0.042	0.009	0.033	0.019	0.005	-0.007
Treatment	(0.017) [0.087]	(0.017) [0.921]	(0.028) [0.717]	(0.024) [0.859]	(0.017) [0.921]	(0.015) [0.921]
Observations	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

ITT coefficients from a linear regression are reported. Clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates, jobcenter-level and province-level characteristics.

Table A6.2 ITT estimates for the impact of JSS Primer on İŞKUR ALMP Services, heterogeneous treatment effects by age

	Job search skills course	Vocational training course	İŞKUR Website service use	JVC meeting	On-the- Job training course	Entrepreneurship training
Young*			-0.027	-0.007	-0.019	-0.036
Treatment	-0.054 (0.018) [0.018]	-0.023 (0.016) [0.457]	(0.029) [0.559]	(0.024) [0.787]	(0.016) [0.549]	(0.014) [0.044]
Observations	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994	3994

ITT coefficients from a linear regression are reported. Clustered standard errors are reported in parentheses () and Romano-Wolf adjusted p-values are reported in brackets [], the latter based on 1000 bootstrap replications. All regressions control for individual-level covariates, jobcenter-level and province-level characteristics.